LST-P3 · PRÁCTICA 04

Interview or conversation

Hoja 04 · Conversación entre dos expertos, ironía y atenuación · dificultad 4 de 4

5 preguntas (16–20) · 1 punto por pregunta · audio: LST-P3_Practica_04.mp3 · la grabación suena dos veces, con las pausas del examen · sin consultar la teoría

You will hear part of a podcast in which two linguists, Ruth Calder and Simon Pryce, discuss whether regional accents in Britain are disappearing. For questions 16–20, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) which fits best according to what you hear.

16 What point does Ruth make about this week's newspaper headlines?

A They underestimate how quickly accents are changing.
B They repeat a prediction that has often been made before.
C They blame the internet for the decline of regional speech.
D They are the result of a misunderstanding of recent research.

17 According to Simon, what is actually happening to regional speech?

A Older people are adopting the speech of their grandchildren.
B Young people increasingly sound like national broadcasters.
C Local features are giving way to those of the nearest city.
D The changes are largely confined to the north-east.

18 What is Simon's opinion of the study on accent prejudice?

A He suspects its findings may not apply to real job interviews.
B He believes it shows that prejudice has largely disappeared.
C He thinks it confirms what other research suggests.
D He feels it was unfair to the students who took part.

19 What does Simon suggest about his own experience of changing his accent?

A He was mocked by other students for the way he spoke.
B He is convinced the change has benefited his career.
C It makes him an objective judge of the issue.
D He has come to regret trying to fit in.

20 Taken as a whole, what do Ruth and Simon suggest about regional accents?

A They are changing rather than dying out.
B Prejudice is now the main threat to their survival.
C Their decline should be a cause for concern.
D Young people care less about them than older generations do.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta. Al corregir, 1 punto por acierto; los errores no restan. En el examen en papel se responde en el cuadernillo y al final hay 5 minutos para pasar las respuestas a la hoja.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
16	A	B	C	D	/ 1
17	A	B	C	D	/ 1
18	A	B	C	D	/ 1
19	A	B	C	D	/ 1
20	A	B	C	D	/ 1
				Total	**/ 5**

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por acierto. Primero la clave rápida; después, la transcripción completa con la frase que da cada respuesta en negrita y el número de la pregunta; por último, por qué la clave es correcta y por qué falla cada distractor, con su tipo (§4) y la cita que lo descarta. Los números de sección remiten a LST_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Tipo de pregunta	Distractores	Teoría
16	**B**	Actitud y opinión	A §4.6 · C §4.1/4.3 · D §4.8	§2.4 · §3.1
17	**C**	Detalle	A §4.6 · B §4.2 · D §4.5	§3.1 · §4.2 · §7.1
18	**A**	Actitud y opinión	B §4.2/4.5 · C §4.4 · D §4.1/4.8	§2.4 · §3.2 · §7.3
19	**D**	Inferencia	A §4.8 · B §4.4/4.5 · C §4.2	§3.1 · §3.4 · §2.4
20	**A**	Global	B §4.6/4.8 · C §4.2 · D §4.8	§7.1 · §7.2 · §3.6

Transcripción

You will hear part of a podcast in which two linguists, Ruth Calder and Simon Pryce, discuss whether regional accents in Britain are disappearing.

Voces · Ruth: Molly, inglés neozelandés · Simon: Ryan, inglés británico

Ruth Welcome back to Word of Mouth. Simon, you'll have seen this week's headlines: regional accents to vanish within fifty years.

Simon I did. I think the first time I saw that headline was in about nineteen ninety-five.

Ruth Exactly. I went back through the archives, and **you can find more or less the same story in every decade since the eighteen nineties** [16]. Radio was going to kill regional speech, then television, then the internet. **And yet here the accents still are.** [20] Part of it is nostalgia, I think: people notice their grandparents' words dying out and assume the whole accent must be going with them. My own grandmother used words I've never heard from anyone else, and I've been listening professionally for twenty years. So you'll forgive me if I'm not reaching for the black armband just yet.

Simon Although, to be fair to the journalists, something is happening. It just isn't what the headline says. If you go to a village in the north-east and record people in their eighties, you'll hear words and vowel sounds that you'll barely hear from their grandchildren. Those really are going. But the grandchildren don't sound like newsreaders. **They sound like everyone else from the nearest big city.** [17]

Ruth Levelling.

Simon Levelling, yes. **The very local differences are being ironed out** [17], and broader regional accents are spreading to take their place. You lose a village and gain a city, if you like. Whether that counts as decline rather depends on what you were attached to in the first place. If it was the village, it's a loss. If it was having a recognisably northern voice, then not much has changed.

Ruth And entirely new accents keep turning up. The way teenagers in East London talk now simply didn't exist forty years ago.

Simon Quite. Multicultural London English, the researchers call it – which is a bit of a mouthful for something you can hear on any bus. And it isn't staying put, either: you can hear bits of it from teenagers in Birmingham and Manchester now.

Ruth What hasn't gone away, unfortunately, is prejudice. There was a study last year in which the same job applicant was rated as less competent when she spoke with certain regional accents. The recordings were identical in every other respect – same script, same qualifications.

Simon I've seen it, and **I'm not entirely convinced** [18], if I'm honest. They played recordings to students and asked them to give each speaker a score. That tells you something about students sitting in a laboratory – and students, let's remember, aren't usually the ones doing the hiring. **Whether it tells you how a real employer behaves in a real interview, I'm less sure.** [18]

Ruth That's one way of looking at it. But there's a great deal of other evidence pointing the same way – from call centres, from courtrooms, from classrooms.

Simon There is, and I'm not saying the prejudice isn't there. I'm saying that particular study doesn't prove very much. Mind you, I'm hardly a neutral observer. I spent my first term at university trying to sound like everybody else, and **I've spent the thirty years since trying to get my old voice back** [19]. Without a great deal of success.

Ruth Do you think the new voice helped your career, though?

Simon People tell me it probably did. Maybe. **I'd honestly rather not know.** [19]

Ruth So where does all this leave us? Our listeners will want to know whether they should be worried.

Simon Worried isn't quite the word. Interested, certainly. **Accents have always been on the move** [20] – they follow trade routes, railways, the people you work with. A fifty-year deadline just makes for a better headline.

Ruth I'll drink to that. **Accents aren't dying – they're changing shape, the way they always have.** [20]

Explicaciones

16 · B · Actitud y opinión

Pregunta: What point does Ruth make about this week's newspaper headlines?

A They underestimate how quickly accents are changing.
Falla (lógica alterada §4.6). Ruth sostiene lo contrario: los titulares anuncian una desaparición que nunca llega (And yet here the accents still are).

B They repeat a prediction that has often been made before.
Correcta. Lo prepara la ironía de Simon (lo vio por primera vez hacia 1995) y lo dice ella: you can find more or less the same story in every decade since the eighteen nineties. Su escepticismo va atenuado (§2.4): I'm not reaching for the black armband just yet.

C They blame the internet for the decline of regional speech.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, no responde §4.3). Internet es solo el último de los culpables que se han ido señalando a lo largo de la historia (Radio was going to kill regional speech, then television, then the internet). No dice que lo culpen los titulares de esta semana.

D They are the result of a misunderstanding of recent research.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Ruth no habla de ninguna investigación reciente ni de dónde salen estos titulares. Lo que señala es que la misma noticia se repite desde hace más de un siglo, y que en parte la alimenta la nostalgia (Part of it is nostalgia).

Teoría: §2.4 Matización · §3.1 Lo que se dice y lo que se da a entender

17 · C · Detalle

Pregunta: According to Simon, what is actually happening to regional speech?

A Older people are adopting the speech of their grandchildren.
Falla (lógica alterada §4.6). Invierte la dirección del cambio: son los nietos los que dejan de usar las palabras de los mayores.

B Young people increasingly sound like national broadcasters.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Lo descarta expresamente: But the grandchildren don't sound like newsreaders.

C Local features are giving way to those of the nearest city.
Correcta. Los nietos sound like everyone else from the nearest big city, y Simon lo generaliza: The very local differences are being ironed out y los acentos regionales más amplios ocupan su lugar. You lose a village and gain a city.

D The changes are largely confined to the north-east.
Falla (grado y alcance §4.5). El nordeste es solo el ejemplo. El fenómeno se presenta como general: Levelling, yes.

Teoría: §3.1 Lo que se dice y lo que se da a entender · §4.2 Mencionado y descartado · §7.1 Part 3: la tarea

18 · A · Actitud y opinión

Pregunta: What is Simon's opinion of the study on accent prejudice?

A He suspects its findings may not apply to real job interviews.
Correcta. I'm not entirely convinced es escepticismo atenuado (§2.4), y explica por qué: el estudio se hizo con estudiantes en un laboratorio. Whether it tells you how a real employer behaves in a real interview, I'm less sure.

B He believes it shows that prejudice has largely disappeared.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2, grado y alcance §4.5). Lo niega: I'm not saying the prejudice isn't there. Critica el estudio, no la existencia del prejuicio.

C He thinks it confirms what other research suggests.
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4). Es el argumento de Ruth (there's a great deal of other evidence pointing the same way). Simon admite que hay más pruebas, pero dice que este estudio en concreto doesn't prove very much.

D He feels it was unfair to the students who took part.
Falla (eco léxico §4.1, ausente §4.8). Recoge students, que eran los participantes. Simon no dice que se les tratara injustamente.

Teoría: §2.4 Matización · §3.2 Voz propia y voces ajenas · §7.3 Seguir a dos voces

19 · D · Inferencia

Pregunta: What does Simon suggest about his own experience of changing his accent?

A He was mocked by other students for the way he spoke.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Es una explicación verosímil de por qué quiso cambiar, pero no la da: nadie se burla de él.

B He is convinced the change has benefited his career.
Falla (voz equivocada §4.4, grado y alcance §4.5). Es lo que le dicen otros (People tell me it probably did), y él lo deja en Maybe.

C It makes him an objective judge of the issue.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Dice lo contrario: I'm hardly a neutral observer.

D He has come to regret trying to fit in.
Correcta. Intentó sonar como los demás (trying to sound like everybody else) y lleva treinta años intentando deshacerlo: I've spent the thirty years since trying to get my old voice back. Quien dedica treinta años a recuperar lo que perdió lamenta haberlo perdido, y I'd honestly rather not know muestra que ni siquiera quiere saber si le compensó. Es la inferencia que se apoya en esas frases (§3.1); el tono no hace falta.

Teoría: §3.1 Lo que se dice y lo que se da a entender · §3.4 Léxico de actitud en las opciones · §2.4 Matización

20 • A • Global

Pregunta: Taken as a whole, what do Ruth and Simon suggest about regional accents?

A They are changing rather than dying out.
Correcta. Es la conclusión de los dos, preparada desde el principio (Ruth: And yet here the accents still are.; Simon: los acentos locales se pierden pero se extienden otros, y aparecen acentos nuevos). Simon: Accents have always been on the move; Ruth: Accents aren't dying – they're changing shape, the way they always have.

B Prejudice is now the main threat to their survival.
Falla (lógica alterada §4.6, ausente §4.8). El prejuicio se discute como un problema para los hablantes, no como algo que amenace la existencia de los acentos.

C Their decline should be a cause for concern.
Falla (mencionado y descartado §4.2). Simon lo rechaza: Worried isn't quite the word. Y Ruth lo celebra: I'll drink to that.

D Young people care less about them than older generations do.
Falla (ausente §4.8). Los jóvenes hablan distinto que sus abuelos, pero nadie dice que les importe menos su forma de hablar. De hecho, crean acentos nuevos.

Teoría: §7.1 Part 3: la tarea · §7.2 Part 3: método · §3.6 Acuerdo y desacuerdo entre hablantes